



Rudy Jackson
Fire Chief

STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

TITLE: OPERATIONS, TECHNICAL RESCUE TEAM
NUMBER: S 6402 R4
EFFECTIVE: OCTOBER 16, 2013
REPLACES: S 6402 R3 (04.04.12)
ACCOUNTABILITY: OPERATIONS
REVIEW CYCLE: ANNUAL

Purpose:

To establish procedures for the organization, training and response by the Fort Worth Fire Department (FWFD) Technical Rescue Team (TRT).

General Information:

I. Mission

- A. To provide advanced search capabilities, extrication expertise and specialized equipment necessary to free victims in situations which exceed the capability of a fire company's expertise and/or equipment.
- B. The TRT may be called to facilitate a rescue or body recovery involving unusual/hazardous circumstances or environments, including but not limited to incidents involving:
 - 1. High/Low Angle Access
 - 2. Confined Spaces
 - 3. Structural Collapse
 - 4. Trench Collapse
 - 5. Vehicular/Machinery Entrapment

II. Organization

- A. The TRT is composed of Stations 1, 2, 14, 38 and a TRT Coordinator.
- B. TRT members are expected to maintain competency in skills needed to safely and effectively perform in all areas of responsibility. Each TRT station's primary areas of responsibility are:
 - 1. Station 1
 - a. High/Low Angle Rope Rescue
 - b. Trench Rescue
 - c. Structural Collapse
 - 2. Station 2
 - a. Confined Space
 - b. Heavy Rescue
 - c. Structural Collapse
 - 3. Station 14
 - a. Heavy Rescue
 - b. Structural Collapse

4. Station 38
 - a. Heavy Rescue
 - b. Structural Collapse

III. Training and Education

- A. TRT members receive a minimum of 40 hours of initial training in Collapse Rescue Operations or equivalent and a minimum of 40 hours of initial training in Level 1 Rope Rescue or equivalent. Equivalent training is determined by the designated Deputy Chief and/or TRT Coordinator. Continued training is conducted quarterly to review standard practices and maintain proficiency. Quarterly training will include but is not limited to the following:
 1. High/Low Angle Rope Rescue
 2. Confined Space Rescue
 3. Structural Collapse Rescue
 4. Trench Collapse Rescue
 5. Vehicular/Industrial Machinery Extrication
- B. The FWFD certifies members who have completed the TRT training requirements.

Instructions/Procedures:

- I. The Operations Assistant Chief shall designate the Deputy Chief responsible for the TRT program.
- II. The designated Deputy Chief shall assign a TRT Coordinator to manage all aspects of the TRT.
- III. TRT station officers shall:
 - A. Assist the TRT Coordinator with:
 1. Maintaining a current roster of certified TRT members and records of all TRT training.
 2. Continued training of personnel under their command.
 3. Evaluation of equipment for their primary areas of responsibility.
 4. Planning and coordinating quarterly training.
 5. Researching and developing new technical rescue techniques that might improve performance or safety.
 - B. Be responsible for ensuring all members under their command are trained and proficient in performing all TRT skills. A minimum of 4 hours TRT continuing education training should be conducted each month.
 - C. Be responsible for ensuring that uncertified personnel assigned to a TRT station are adequately trained to provide a supporting role in any TRT response.
 - D. Be responsible for documenting all training on form F.D. 625, TRT Training Record, and forwarding documentation to the TRT Coordinator.

IV. Response

- A. The Fire Alarm Office (FAO) shall dispatch the appropriate TRT response for the specific type of emergency and notify the Shift Deputy Chief. FAO may upgrade the initial dispatch based on call details.
1. Confined Space Emergencies — Emergencies involving entrapment or incapacitation in any space that has a limited means of entry or exit, (e.g. vessels, tanks, hoppers, vaults, sewer lines, etc.) dispatch:
 - a. Closest fire unit
 - b. Closest satellite hazmat unit
 - c. Closest Battalion Chief
 - d. Closest TRT station
 - e. Station 2
 - f. Battalion 2 Chief
 2. Trench Emergencies — Emergencies involving entrapment due to collapsed soil or materials such as gravel, grain, or any other emergency where there may be a need for shoring, dispatch:
 - a. Closest fire unit
 - b. Closest Battalion Chief
 - c. Stations 1 and 2
 - d. Station 14 or 38 depending on Automatic Vehicle Locator (AVL) recommendation
 - e. Battalion 2 Chief
 3. High/Low Angle Rescue Emergencies — Emergencies including but not limited to above or below grade incidents where the use of rope rescue is required (e.g. towers, multi-story buildings, ravines, etc.) dispatch:
 - a. Closest fire unit
 - b. Closest Battalion Chief
 - c. Station 1
 - d. Station 2, 14 or 38 depending on AVL recommendation
 - e. Battalion 2 Chief
 4. Heavy Rescue Emergencies — Emergencies involving the need for technical extrication knowledge or equipment such as air bags, cribbing/shoring equipment, hydraulic rams, cutting tools, etc. Accidents involving an overturned truck/heavy equipment, passenger bus or van with a report of people trapped, train derailment, entrapment in industrial machinery, or accidents on a freeway with a report of people trapped, dispatch:
 - a. Closest fire unit
 - b. Closest Battalion Chief
 - c. Squad 2, Rescue 14 or Rescue 38 depending on AVL recommendation.
 - d. Battalion 2 Chief
 5. Structural Collapse – Emergencies including but not limited to search or rescue of victims that would require the use of building shoring equipment or specialized equipment to ensure the safety of rescue personnel, (e.g., structural collapse due to storm, deterioration of structural components, or collapse due to other means), dispatch:
 - a. Closest fire unit
 - b. Closest Battalion Chief

- c. Stations 1 and 2
- d. Station 14 or 38 depending on AVL recommendation
- e. Battalion 2 Chief

V. Command

- A. The Incident Command System shall be utilized at all TRT incidents.
- B. The Incident Commander (IC) shall assume overall strategic command of the rescue operation.
- C. An experienced TRT officer shall be designated as the Rescue Branch or Group Officer and shall:
 - 1. Assist the IC in developing an action plan with the following considerations:
 - a. Nature of emergency
 - b. Type of rescue required
 - c. Location, number of victims, and types of injuries
 - d. Equipment requirements
 - e. Environmental factors
 - f. Size of command structure needed
 - g. Additional specialized equipment/skills required
 - h. Back-up plan
 - 2. Assign an experienced TRT member as Safety Officer.
 - 3. Assign personnel to needed functions, (e.g., rigging, entry, back-up, etc.)

VI. Safety

- A. Safety shall be the first priority of any TRT operation and a dedicated rescue Safety Officer shall be assigned as soon as possible.
- B. An experienced TRT member shall be assigned as Safety Officer for the rescue activity on all TRT operations. The Safety Officer shall ensure that all safety procedures and proper steps are followed. The Safety Officer shall have the authority to halt any operation they deem unsafe. Operations shall resume only after consultation between the IC, Safety Officer, and rescue supervisor.
- C. The TRT shall not operate outside their scope of training or exceed the capabilities of their equipment.

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